

Comprehensive Key Differences: HSA HealthShare Comparison

Key structural differences, limits, and guidelines.

Comparison Core	Secure HSA	HSA HealthShare
Enrollment Deadlines	Strict Deadline: Cannot enroll or submit applications after the 20th of the month for the following cycle.	Flexible Enrollment: Fully permits enrollment and activation even after the 20th of the month.
Member Responsibility Tiers	Offers 3 tiers for Initial Unshareable Amounts (IUA): \$1,250, \$2,500, and \$5,000.	Provides maximum choice with 18 different Member Responsibility Amount (MRA) tier options.
Household Cap Limitations	A household is responsible for up to 3 IUAs in a rolling 12-month period.	A household is responsible for up to 2 MRAs in a rolling 12-month period (with maternity and pre-existing conditions as exceptions).
Maternity & Family Perks	Standard maternity cost-sharing for delivery and prenatal care; no supplementary infant consumer product benefits.	Features an enhanced family program providing 6 months of free diapers alongside maternity allowances.
Maternity Waiting Periods	Enforces a strict 6-month waiting period.	Enforces a 30-day waiting period.
Prenatal/Postnatal Care	Features no upper sharing limit on routine prenatal and postnatal office-based care.	Capped at \$6,000 per request (an additional \$1,000 is available if the pregnancy is officially diagnosed as high-risk).
Scheduled Surgeries & Pre-Approval	No pre-approval required for eligible non-emergency, scheduled surgical procedures.	Requires mandatory prior medical review and approval for all non-emergent, scheduled surgical procedures to qualify for sharing.
Mental Health Care	Sharing is not eligible for mental health crises or emergency room evaluations.	Emergency mental health evaluations and related emergency room expenses are eligible for sharing.
Pre-Existing Management	Does not share in the maintenance or ongoing management of pre-existing conditions.	Does not share in the maintenance or ongoing management of pre-existing conditions.
Pre-Existing Look-Back	Utilizes a standard 24-month look-back period to evaluate conditions existing prior to membership.	Utilizes a standard 12-month look-back period for most conditions (extended to 36 months for cancer).
Pre-Existing Exceptions	Exempts controlled high blood pressure, cholesterol, and Diabetes (Types 1 and 2) from pre-existing limitations.	Exempts controlled high blood pressure, cholesterol, thyroid conditions, and Type 2 Diabetes only .

Comparison Core	Secure HSA	HSA HealthShare
International Medical	Restricted strictly to emergency and acute sudden-onset care. No scheduled travel medical or preventive international care.	Eligible for emergency care, plus members may travel for medically necessary scheduled procedures if the cost is lower than comparable treatment in the US.
Prescription Drugs	Shares in prescription drugs directly related to any approved, eligible medical need if ordered by a licensed healthcare provider.	Sharing up to \$125,000 or 12 months of continuous medication costs per request.
Tobacco Restrictions	Adds a \$50/month surcharge . Imposes a \$50,000 lifetime sharing cap on major health categories for tobacco/cannabis users within 15 years.	Applies a \$100/month surcharge . The surcharge can be completely removed after 12 months of non-use with medical documentation.
Medical Injections	Eligible injections are shareable up to \$5,000 . Eligible hormone therapy injections are capped at \$3,000 . Sex reassignment injections are ineligible.	Subject to defined sharing allowances; includes stem cell, PRP, nerve blocks, trigger points, and non-maternity epidurals. Sex reassignment injections are ineligible.
Therapeutic Treatments	Eligible expenses are shareable up to a maximum financial cap of \$7,500 OR 35 visits per medical need (whichever comes first).	Recovery and fusion therapies are shareable up to a limit of \$3,500 per request .
Alternative Medicine	Requires alternative treatments to be prescribed by a licensed professional for an approved need; no return-to-care financial penalties.	Eligible under a \$2,500 allowance . Requires provider notes, cost estimates, and can limit future conventional sharing if you switch back.
Congenital Conditions	Not eligible for sharing.	If unknown prior to membership, congenital conditions are eligible up to \$125,000 once per membership lifetime. Pre-ex is not eligible for sharing.

Important Notice: All organizational rules, cost-sharing caps, membership surcharges, and medical allowances detailed in this comparative document are subject to change based on updates to community guidelines. Members should reference their complete, specific membership handbooks for full details.